

popular operating system in the world, and that they should probably use it in more places. In the past Microsoft's different platforms have had rather different APIs and even different kernels.

Before Windows 8, the mobile, desktop and the Xbox's OS stacks were very different. Windows for desktops used the Windows NT kernel, phones used the CE kernel and the Xbox used its own special kernel. Windows Phone 8 finally switched to the NT kernel making it a lot similar to Windows for desktops. Xbox One further converged these platforms by switching to the same kernel as Windows 8.

While converging these kernels might have made things easier for Microsoft, it didn't benefit other developers as much.

With Windows 10 comes a true convergence of all devices to the same Windows kernel, 'universal hardware drivers', and 'standard network and I/O'. This in essence is what Windows Core is.

Not only has Windows Core expanded to all devices that already supported Windows, but the breadth of devices that support Windows has also expanded. For instance, other than PCs, tablets, and phones, the Xbox One will also soon update to use the Windows 10 core, it is already available for the Raspberry Pi 2, and of course Microsoft's new HoloLens also runs Windows 10 core.

Consolidation and convergence are huge themes with Windows 10. After unifying the Windows core across platforms Microsoft has also unified the development SDKs across platforms into what they call the Universal Windows Platform (UWP).



Universal Windows Apps can run on any Windows platform and use techniques such as adaptive UIs to run on different form factors and with different kinds of interactions patterns.